

ERU'S LOICO

Civilization has collapsed beyond recognition. No kingdoms rise above the wilds, no empires chart the coasts. The roads that once bound the races together (for better or for worse) have vanished beneath root and soil. Humans, elves, dwarves, halflings, and the rest now live as scattered tribes and small bands of hunter-gatherers, clinging to survival in a world that seems to reject their existence.

Every settlement, no matter how carefully hidden or fortified, eventually falls — to beasts from the dark, storms that tear through the land, or inexplicable forces that twist nature itself. People speak of “The **Unmaking**,” a curse that ensures that nothing endures. Whether it is divine punishment, the consequence of lost magic, or something far worse, no one knows. Every attempt a flicker above a dimming wick, braving a raging storm. The brief, trembling sparks are snuffed out before the world can even remember their warmth.

The sky itself seems dimmer than it should be. The sun burns with a weary light, and the nights stretch long, pierced by forgotten constellations that shift with the seasons. The land is wild and primal. Forests have reclaimed the ancient markers of civilization. Mountains are littered with the bones of forgotten machines and half-buried towers. Even the land trembles at times, writhing in pain as it heals from wounds now forgotten.

Whispers will sometimes tell of adventurer's experiences of great ruins of

cities well-forgotten, bearing runes no living scholar can read. Others appear to be of lone fragments of cities — isolated towers melted like wax, doorways that lead to no hearth, and farms with no logistical routes.

However, the city of Ahr endures like a memory that refuses to fade. It is the last great city of the plane, sprawling across the base of vicious encroaching mountains, topped by mist obscuring the peaks. A fog often shields the city from sight in the morning, burning away at midday. Stone walls and crooked towers rise from a basin of green and gray, their surfaces slick with age and rain. The air is heavy here though not oppressive. Through it, lies the clamor of the city center.



A rough picture of Ahr using a balloon and a pin-hole camera along with annotations labeling districts and places of interest. It should be noted that the plaza in the center hosts a new park not pictured.

The center is a vast circular plaza of pale stone worn smooth by centuries of countless footsteps. Traders spread woven mats and wooden tables across the flagstones, displaying their meager wares: stale bread, old rusted tools, pale fruits grown in shadowed fields. Around the plaza, arched colonnades of marble

crumble under ivy and soot, their columns marred with soot and ash from fires fought and won at a great cost.

Life hums quietly here. The sound of coin against wood, the creak of carts, the whisper of countless cautious voices. Music is rare but not absent; some nights a flute's soft tune winds through the alleyways, a fragile act of defiance against the ever-present tension.

From the mountains to the North, the River Ardent cuts through the heart of Ahr, running under the city center, providing a source of fresh water. The Ardent river curves away and descends lower into the ground and leaks its way into a boundless and bare desert stretching far along with the lone and level sands. The banks are lined with low walls and cobbled walkways where fishermen mend nets and children watch upon the statue of Ahr's founder, his defiant shield holding up the sky; the city's perseverance juxtaposed with its forgotten namesake. The river divides the city neatly, a cut in the earth, its bridges the suture flexing as it holds the world together.

By night, the waters shimmer faintly, casting long trembling reflections upon the old facades. People whisper that as long as the river runs clear, the city will endure. When the current darkens — and sometimes it does — they bolt their doors and whisper old names in the dark, their last resort.

To the northeast, where the ground rises toward the old citadel walls, stand the **Terraces (Wealthy Estates)**, the last remnants of the city's wealth. The streets

here are broad and straight, lined with chiselled marble made with techniques long since untrained, the marble now dulled to bone-white and featureless. Gardens bloom in terraced courtyards, fed by the river through cunning channels that only the engineers of the old age could have built.



Ahr, the last bastion of civilization, shielded from the cruel world by mist and mountains, holds a market in the city center.

The noble houses — what few remain — are enclosed behind wrought-iron gates and high windows. The people of the Terrace wear fine but faded clothing, relics of a lineage muddled and uncertain. Their voices are soft and rehearsed, their smiles empty. They host quiet feasts under candlelight, eating from brass and copper, the silver that once overflowed their coppers robbed from them and never replaced.

Beyond the centre, the streets grow narrow and twisted, choked with wooden dwellings leaning together for warmth. Smoke curls from a thousand chimneys, carrying the scent of burnt grain and animal fat. Here lies the **Outer Ring**, the

working soul of Ahr; mostly inhabited by weavers, butchers, and other producers, all living within the rhythm of quiet desperation.

At night, the city's edge glows faintly in the dark — not with fire, but with something softer, like moonlight caught in mist. The people do not speak of it, though all know it marks the line none should cross. Beyond that glow lie the farmlands, half-swallowed by fog, where farmers sow and reap in silence. They say the earth itself grows uneasy out there, the tools dull too quickly, the livestock stare at unseen shapes in the treeline, and sometimes, whole homesteads vanish between one dawn and the next.



A hamlet barely a mile outside of Ahr, mainly used for share-croppers and their basket of deplorables.

The farmlands and hamlets sprawl outward until they dissolve into emptiness. Crops cling weakly to thin soil; the air feels hollow. It is said the wind does not sound the same beyond a certain point — it carries no echo, no scent, no life. The farmers who live nearest the edge build their homes low and close to the earth, burning lanterns at all hours. They seldom speak to travelers and rarely cross back into the heart of the city.

And yet, even here, life persists. Wheat still grows. Water still flows. The world may be crumbling, but within Ahr, something refuses to die — a stubborn spark, a collective will, a fragile peace that has somehow lasted against all odds when even their Pantheon had abandoned them.

THE PEOPLE OF AHR

The people of Ahr live in a strange balance of freedom and fear. There is a council, each member governs a district itself by habit and necessity with matters of the state held by quorum. There are many differences but all are united by fear of that beyond Ahr.

The inhabitants move through their days with quiet purpose: smiths hammering dull metal into tools that will rust before the season turns, farmers bringing baskets of thin wheat to market, teachers reciting letters to children who may not live long enough to master them. Smiles come slow and fade quickly. They have learned to measure joy like rations — sparingly, and with care. For while their city is safe, for the moment, danger looms beyond the city limits.

Although, occasionally someone is born “a **Makar**” — able to conjure fire from air or speak to animals — but such individuals rarely live long. The world fears them, and worse, the world *seems to hunt them*. There are no teachers, no leaders for these **makars** and few allies willing to risk their lives and their families lives for them, so these **makars** choose to suppress their abilities and forget that they can do these wondrous things. Until a man “Hanz” did

the impossible and made others feel hopeful.

Long before Hanz became a name spoken with admiration, he was just a man with a hoarse voice and worn boots who refused to accept Ahr's near imperceptible but sure collapse. He came from the Outer Ring, the son of a weaver, known to speak plainly.



Hanz (no family name). Leader, organizer and commander of the Revanchists, though he despises the name. Here, he is managing the collapse of the city wall in Ahr - preventing never-seen-before evils to wreck havoc.

He was not a noble, nor a soldier, nor a priest. But he could organize, and more importantly, he *could inspire*. In recent years the number of attacks on the farmlands beyond Ahr has increased, jeopardizing the main food source for the thousands of residents of Ahr, and the city guard failed to protect those beyond the Outer Ring. That's when Hanz started gathering people: farmers who'd lost kin, retired hunters, masons, even former thieves.

Hanz studied his group as they trained, and studied their successes, and losses, in battle. He began to learn, and in time, teach. Things changed slowly at first, a few more successful reports of defenses along

the outer wall, less casualties from combat, until suddenly, no farmers were reported missing in a fortnight and then a 2nd fortnight.

This group does not wear uniforms and had no immediate name for themselves. However, it so happens that soon they would be given a name by all those in the land containing **Eru's Loico**. They are:

THE REVANCHISTS

Welcome to Bas-on-Ti, a ramshackle hamlet, today celebrating its 2nd anniversary since it was founded by settlers and warriors from Ahr. It is a joyous day. This is proof that the Revanchists have affected real change and made a foothold into the void that stretches beyond the world of Ahr.

*You look around at the inside of the oldest building, **Sitzfleish**, the pub, and see your fellow Revanchists. A hardy group, now just short of a hundred. Built by settlers from Ahr, its timbers were still raw, pale wood streaked with resin that bled whenever the sun warmed them. The town still smells of sawdust and fresh earth.*

Roofs sag under thatch and mud, and the rough palisade around the town was more promising than protection with some gaps wide enough for wolves to slip through, shadows falling long in the early evening. Luckily the fires and commotion repelled most beasts.

Inside the walls, life struggled to root itself. The streets were little more than packed dirt, muddied by cattle hooves and cart wheels. Smoke from cookfires curled through the air, carrying the smells of roasted grain, boiled turnips, and pine. Besides the pub, Jal's General, Smitty's smithy, Zhams Outpost, and some shared housing round out the rest of Bas-on-Ti.

Beyond the hamlet stretched farmland, thin and stubborn, hacked out of the wild. The settlers' fields ran up against the forest's edge, where ancient trees loomed, their mossy roots like old bones pushing through the soil. The people spoke uneasily of that forest, of strange stones hidden beneath the undergrowth, carved in spirals no one could read, and of wolves whose eyes gleamed with unnatural light when the moon rose.



Bas-on-Ti on the eve of its 2nd anniversary of its founding. This small hamlet is on the precipice of the unknown and serves as the last bulwark of civilization. This has not only been your home for the last two years, but it is also your beaming testament against the horrors of the natural world.

WEST MARCHES PLAYER'S GUIDE

Welcome to our West Marches D&D campaign. This guide explains how this style of play differs from a traditional D&D campaign, what is expected of you as a player, and the character creation rules that define this world.

Please read this carefully: West Marches campaigns thrive on shared understanding and player initiative.

WHAT IS A WEST MARCHES CAMPAIGN?

A West Marches campaign is an open-world, player-driven style of D&D. Instead of a fixed party and a linear story, the world exists in tandem with the story of the other characters, and you decide where to go, when to explore, and who joins you. Each mini-arc (designed to last 3-5 sessions on the timescale of a month IRL) should be considered to be occurring contemporaneously.

Think of it less like a novel and more like a shared world and expedition log. Here there are no "main characters" in the traditional sense - rather you are all building the story together. Be sure to collaborate on information on quests at the *quest board* and other important details on a shared journal.

ChatGPT gives a decent breakdown of West Marches vs. Traditional D&D that I have chosen to leave here.

TRADITIONAL CAMPAIGN

- Fixed party that meets regularly
- DM-driven overarching narrative
- Story progresses session-to-session regardless of who attends
- Characters often have tightly interwoven backstories
- Party composition is mostly static

WEST MARCHES CAMPAIGN

- No fixed party; groups form per expedition
- The world does not scale to you—danger is real, unknown and uneven
- Characters come and go naturally (either by natural causes or unnatural).

- Exploration, survival, and discovery are central

The DM will assemble parties based on availability and first come first serve basis. If your character is not present, they were not there (and that's okay!).

- Players propose expeditions based off of a quest board:
 - Quest/Goal
 - Date/time
- Each session is a relatively self-contained expedition that begins and ends in a safe settlement whenever possible.

THE WORLD PHILOSOPHY

- Civilization is safe. The wilderness is not. However, at Session 0, there are only 2 bastions of civilization.
- The map begins blank.
- Knowledge is valuable and must be earned.
- Retreat is often the correct decision. Encounters will be deadly as some have been designed for lvl 1 PCs and some have been designed for lvl 10 PCs. Almost every quest can be started at any level..

Information gained by one group becomes part of the shared world—player journals, maps, rumors, and discoveries matter.

NEW CHARACTER CREATION RULES

- All player characters should probably begin as a martial class at Level 1 (though this is optional).
- If a spellcaster class is chosen, **the PC may not use magic in any sense until lvl 2.** This includes innate features granted by class at lvl 1.

This is because in this world, there is zero shared knowledge of magic and other arcane arts. This reflects the harsh reality

of your society as much knowledge of arcana and religion are lost. If you so choose to become a magical class (and you should), you will **discover** magic as you naturally earn power through survival and discovery. When magic is discovered for one, it is learned for all (with appropriate time delays).

Therefore, multiclassing is expected. In fact, due to the nature of West Marches, characters are assumed to grow into more specialized through experience and that should be kept in mind.

Keep character backstories focused on the background I have created. Though destitute, Ahr is a full-fledged city, and if you wish to be a noble or a criminal, those backgrounds can very easily fit in this campaign. A PC background about how you were cast out of a magical order may not work well here. Think Waterdeep but... shallow.

ADVANCEMENT & CONSEQUENCES

- Leveling is typically tied to:
 - Successful expeditions
 - Major discoveries
- Though death is not permanent, it will be tough to circumvent.
- Magic will progress naturally

FINAL THOUGHT

This campaign rewards curiosity and exploration similarly to combat. There is an emphasis on preparation and cooperation.

'The Revanchists were forged where comfort died—under fire, in mud and ash, in the long stretch of fear between battles. You and I are bound by a comradeship tested in war's crucible, hardened by loss, and held together by a grim faith in the ideals and institutions that gave life meaning in Ahr.' - Hanz

Welcome to Eru's Loico: Renaissance.

DM Rules and Homebrew

Just a quick guide on how Eru's Loico: Renaissance will play out.

Ruleset

Eru's Loico will use 5.5e (2024). This will be a bit of a learning curve (even for the DM). Many rule disputes will be handled by reddit/google searches. Rule of cool always applies.

Homebrewed Rules

Since I've last DM'ed, I've picked up on a few neat new homebrewed rules. I've listed every homebrew rule that will make an appearance in this campaign.

The unknown homebrew rule

There is one special condition that is not made known to players. It will be revealed once conditions are met (though it may not be met for some time). It largely is extremely beneficial to PCs.

Standard Homebrews

Potions can be consumed (and rolled for) as a bonus action (e.g. /r 2d4 + 2 for avg. 7 hp) or can be consumed as an action for the full HP value (e.g. 10 hp).

"I know a guy." - Roll a d4 - you can make up that many facts about a person you may know that might be able to help you out. Success may vary.

Town Quest Board

Quests will roll in and be posted on a quest board. Sometimes quest details will be misleading or provide incorrect information - all depending on who posted the notice! Treat them with a grain of salt!

Eru's Loico Wealth

A bustling economy does not exist here. There are few gold reserves in Ahr. Silver

is more abundant but not more so than copper. 1 gp is a year's wage and ~10 sp a month's (1gp = 100 sp). Costs for equipment are reduced to 1/100 of standard value. For example, hide armor traditionally is valued at 10 gp. In Eru's Loico, it is priced at 10 sp.

A quick trick to remember is simply by shifting the unit. gp -> sp -> cp

Drugs

Why aren't drugs exploited more often? Be careful what you drink... All concocted potions have a DC15 Medicine check to see if there is a bad reaction. If failed, then there is a 1d40 table of adverse (and beneficial) effects. Effects are addicting!

Costly Unconsciousness

+1 Level of exhaustion upon revival

Dazed

The condition "Dazed" may make its appearance. Dazed is somewhat less punishing than "stunned" while still maintaining gravitas when considering turn order.

Dual Concentration

To concentrate on two spells at the same time, the feat "Dual Concentration" must be taken. Dual concentration requires the spellcaster to use their action and bonus action to maintain concentration with a concentration check (DC 8 + Spell Lvl + Spell Lvl) or drop dual concentration on both spells. On a fail, dual concentration is dropped at the end of the turn and the caster gains a level of exhaustion. A caster may use their bonus action to drop dual concentration on Movement is 1 ft per every 5 ft. The combined spell level must be less than or equal to the highest spell slot your spellcaster knows (e.g., Lvl 13 Wizard Bob can use a 7th level spell and therefore dual casts Haste @ lvl 3 and Greater Invisibility @ lvl 4)

Silvery Barbs

Requires concentration to be cast. This brings a minor debuff to the spell - ensuring that the cost of silvery barbs is weighted before use.

Cover and half cover

Introduces cover, half cover (+2), 75% cover (+5) bonuses to AC.

Flanking

Opposite of halfcover (+2) to hit, no advantage.

Flavor Feat

At character creation, PCs are granted an extra feat solely for flavor purposes. The feat should purely be non-combat.

Crit Flavor Buff

A critical success on an attack roll requires the defender to roll a Survival skill check. DC 10 or half the damage, whichever is higher. On a failure, the defender's weapon will be ripped from them. On critical failure, armor will be damaged (resulting in the loss of its effect) and will need to be repaired.

Stealth flavor + Group Stealth

NPCs will have an alertness level depending on the situation ranging from normal, alert, and high alert. Upon failure, alert levels will change resulting in "something". When groups of PCs collectively try to be stealthy, the group roll is rolled against the average passive perception per PC.

Vision and Darkvision

When searching in darkness, roll a perception check with disadvantage.

When searching in darkness with darkvision, roll a perception check.

Persuasion vs Intimidation

PCs will no longer choose to persuade or intimidate but instead this will be based on factions/reputation/notoriety.

Arcana vs Detect Magic

PCs can use an arcana check to detect the presence of magic only. Detect magic will be used to determine the school of magic and potential effects/uses. Arcana checks will otherwise be used for learning magic spells or other situational cases.

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Greenish. #e2efc6

Monster Stat Block Background. #fdf1dc

Page Setup

Margins: Top: 0.5, Bottom: 0.5, Sides: 0.6, Center: 0.3

Tips and Tricks

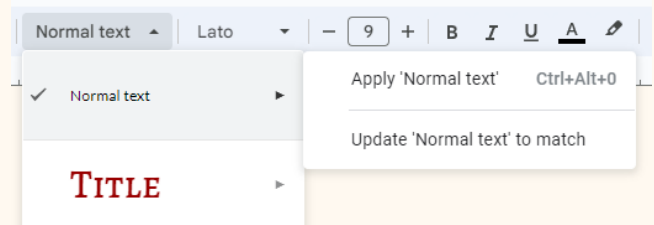
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Changing the Style

If you wish to change the styles used in this doc you should always update them in the drop down menu to make sure they are consistent throughout the doc.



Bullet Point Lists

I don't use the built in enumerations as I find their spacing and indentation is not to my taste. That is why I simply use the character "•" with a space in front for my lists.

For ease of use you can add a "shortcut" under **Tools > Preferences > Substitutions**. For example I added the substitution "***" → "•". That way whenever I want to make a simple list of a few items I can easily insert this • symbol.



Other Template Docs in This Style

- > [DnD Homebrew Doc Template](#)
- > [DnD Game Doc Template](#)
- > [DnD Player Character Draft Doc](#)
- > [DnD Party Draft Doc](#)

Layout Values

Colors

Other Objects

Tables

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Table Title (Heading 5)

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D20 Table

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Split Table

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Blocks & Sidebars

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The Class													
	Proficiency Bonus	Features	Cantrips Known	Spells Known	-- Spell Slots per Spell Level --								
Level					1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th	8th	9th
1st	+2	Feature, Feature	4	2	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2nd	+2		4	3	3	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
3rd	+2		4	4	4	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
4th	+2	Ability Score Improvement	5	5	4	3	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
5th	+3		5	6	4	3	2	-	-	-	-	-	-
6th	+3		5	7	4	3	3	-	-	-	-	-	-
7th	+3		5	8	4	3	3	1	-	-	-	-	-
8th	+3	Ability Score Improvement	5	9	4	3	3	2	-	-	-	-	-
9th	+4		5	10	4	3	3	3	1	-	-	-	-
10th	+4		6	11	4	3	3	3	2	-	-	-	-
11th	+4		6	12	4	3	3	3	2	1	-	-	-
12th	+4	Ability Score Improvement	6	12	4	3	3	3	2	1	-	-	-
13th	+5		6	13	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	-	-
14th	+5		6	13	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	-	-
15th	+5		6	14	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	1	-
16th	+5	Ability Score Improvement	6	14	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	1	-
17th	+6		6	15	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	1	1
18th	+6		6	15	4	3	3	3	3	1	1	1	1
19th	+6	Ability Score Improvement	6	15	4	3	3	3	3	2	1	1	1
20th	+6		6	15	4	3	3	3	3	2	2	1	1

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Class Features

As a __ you gain the following class features.

Hit Points

Hit Dice: 1dX per __ level

Hit Points at 1st Level: X + your Con modifier

Hit Points at Higher Levels: 1dX + your Con mod. per __ level after 1st

Proficiencies

Armor:

Weapons:

Tools:

Saving Throws:

Skills:

Equipment

You start with the following equipment, in addition to the equipment granted by your background:

- (a) a X or (b) a Y
- Two Z

Class Feature

Beginning at 1st level, you lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consetetur sadipscing elitr, sed diam nonumy eirmod tempor. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consetetur sadipscing elitr, sed diam nonumy eirmod tempor.

Subclasses

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Subclass

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Subclass Feature

At 3rd level, you lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consetetur sadipscing elitr, sed diam nonumy eirmod tempor.

Race

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Description, Flavor & Backstory

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Race Names

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Abc Names:

Test, Blubb, test. test. test, test, test, test, test, test, test, test

Xyz Names:

Lasdb, Odan, Lhas, Test, Blubb, test. test. test, test, test, test, test, test, test, test

Race Traits

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Ability Score Increase. +2 Str and +1 Wis

Age.

Alignment.

Size.

Speed.

Feature.

Languages.

Subrace.

Subrace 1

Short Description

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Ability Score Increase. +2 Str and +1 Wis

Feature.

Stat Blocks

Adult Red Dragon

Huge dragon, chaotic evil

Armor Class 19 (natural armor)

Hit Points 256 (19d12 + 133)

Speed 40ft., climb 40ft., fly 80ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
27 (+8)	10 (+0)	25 (+7)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)	21 (+5)

Saving Throws Dex +6, Con +13, Wis +7, Cha +11

Skills Perception +13, Stealth +6

Damage Immunities fire

Senses blindsight 60 ft., darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 23

Languages Common, Draconic

Challenge 17 (18,000 XP)

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If the dragon fails a saving throw, it can choose to succeed instead.

Actions

Multiattack. The dragon can use its Frightful Presence. It then makes three attacks: one with its bite and two with its claws.

Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +14 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. Hit: 19 (2d10 + 8) piercing damage plus 7 (2d6) fire damage.

Claw. Melee Weapon Attack: +14 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 15 (2d6 + 8) slashing damage.

Tail. Melee Weapon Attack: +14 to hit, reach 15 ft., one target. Hit: 17 (2d8 + 8) bludgeoning damage.

Frightful Presence. Each creature...

Fire Breath (Recharge 5–6). The dragon exhales fire in a 60-foot cone. Each creature in that area must make a DC 21 Dexterity saving throw, taking 63 (18d6) fire damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one.

Legendary Actions

The dragon can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The dragon regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Detect. The dragon makes a Wisdom (Perception) check.

Tail Attack. The dragon makes a tail attack.

Wing Attack (Costs 2 Actions). The dragon beats its wings. Each creature within 10 feet of the dragon must succeed on a DC 22 Dexterity saving throw or take 15 (2d6 + 8) bludgeoning damage and be knocked prone. The dragon can then fly up to half its flying speed.

Appendix: d100 Table

D100 Table

d100	Entry
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